

Last Updated: October 30, 2025 at 12:54 p.m. PT

Competition Agenda - Day One

Friday, November 7, 2025
8:45 a.m. – 5:00 p.m. PT
Middlebury Institute of International
Studies at Monterey
#Cyber912
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| 8:45 – 9:15 a.m. | Breakfast Served & Registration (McCone Atrium) |
| 9:15 – 9:30 a.m. | Welcoming Remarks (Irvine Auditorium, McCone Building, 499 Pierce St)
<i>Safa Shahwan Edwards, Director, Capacity Building & Communities, Cyber Statecraft Initiative, Atlantic Council</i>

<i>Philipp Bleek, Professor and Co-Coordinator, Cyber Collaborative, Middlebury Institute of International Studies at Monterey</i> |
| 9:30 – 10:00 a.m. | The Evolution of US Cyber Strategy (Irvine Auditorium, McCone)
<i>Jacquelyn Schneider, Hargrove Hoover Fellow, Director, Hoover Wargaming and Crisis Simulation Initiative, Hoover Institution</i> |
| 10:00 – 10:20 a.m. | Competitors' Briefing (Irvine Auditorium, McCone)
<i>Urmita Chowdhury, Assistant Director, Cyber Statecraft Initiative, Atlantic Council</i>

<i>Safa Shahwan Edwards, Director, Capacity Building & Communities, Cyber Statecraft Initiative, Atlantic Council</i> |
| 10:00 – 10:20 a.m. | Judges' Briefing (McCone 238)
<i>Morgan McMurray, Associate Director, Cyber Statecraft Initiative, Atlantic Council</i>

<i>Jake Lopata, Graduate Assistant, Middlebury Institute of International Studies at Monterey</i> |
| 10:30 – 12:00 p.m. | Morning Qualifying Rounds (McGowan 100, McGowan 102, Morse B104, Morse B105, Center for the Blue Economy Room 1 and 2)
Wave 1 10:30 - 11:10 a.m. Wave 2 11:20 – 12:00 p.m. |
| 12:00 – 1:00 p.m. | Lunch Served (Taco Truck on Pierce Street) |

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- 1:00 – 2:00 p.m.** **Panel Discussion: Emerging National Security Threats Across Sectors (Irvine Auditorium, McCone)**
Jeffrey Lewis, Director, CNS East Asia Nonproliferation Program, Middlebury Institute of International Studies at Monterey
- Cervando Bañuelos II, Senior Product Security Engineer, Aurora*
- Melissa Oh, Managing Director, TGY Advisors LLC*
- Pavan Gill, U.S. Department of Defense (Ret.)*
- Moderated by:**
Habiba Mickdad, Cyber Collaborative Student Lead, Middlebury Institute of International Studies at Monterey
- 2:00 – 2:15 p.m.** **[Optional] Afternoon Judges' Briefing (McCone 238)**
Morgan McMurray, Associate Director, Cyber Statecraft Initiative, Atlantic Council
- 2:30 – 4:00 p.m.** **Afternoon Qualifying Rounds (McGowan100, McGowan102, Morse B104, Morse B105, Center for the Blue Economy (CBE) Room 1 and 2)**
Wave 3 2:30 – 3:10 p.m. | Wave 4 3:20 – 4:00 p.m.
- 4:00 – 4:30 p.m.** **BREAK**
- 4:30 – 4:45 p.m.** **Individual Awards Ceremony (Irvine Auditorium, McCone)**
Morgan McMurray, Associate Director, Cyber Statecraft Initiative, Atlantic Council
- Philipp Bleek, Professor and Co-Coordinator, Cyber Collaborative, Middlebury Institute of International Studies at Monterey*
- 4:45 – 5:00 p.m.** **Announcement of Semi-Finalists (Irvine Auditorium, McCone)**
Safa Shahwan Edwards, Director, Capacity Building & Communities, Cyber Statecraft Initiative, Atlantic Council
- 5:30 – 7:00 p.m.** **Evening Social (Samson Center, 453 Van Buren St)**
- 6:30 p.m.** **Release of Intelligence Report II**

Competition Agenda - Day Two

Saturday, November 8, 2025
8:45 a.m. – 5:00 p.m. PT
Middlebury Institute of International
Studies at Monterey
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- 8:45 - 9:00 a.m.** **Breakfast Served & Registration (McCone Atrium)**
- 9:00 - 9:30 a.m.** **Keynote Address: North Korea Is Just a Cyber Criminal Organization Pretending to Be a Nation State (Irvine Auditorium, McCone)**
Allan Liska, Threat Intelligence Researcher, Recorded Future
- Introduction by:
Karen Nershi, Professor and Director, Cyber Collaborative, Middlebury Institute of International Studies at Monterey
- 9:30 - 9:50 a.m.** **Competitor Open Q&A Time (Irvine Auditorium, McCone)**
Urmita Chowdhury, Assistant Director, Cyber Statecraft Initiative, Atlantic Council
- Safa Shahwan Edwards, Director, Capacity Building & Communities, Cyber Statecraft Initiative, Atlantic Council*
- 9:30 - 9:50 a.m.** **Judges' Briefing (McCone 238)**
Morgan McMurray, Associate Director, Cyber Statecraft Initiative, Atlantic Council
- Jake Lopata, Graduate Assistant, Middlebury Institute of International Studies at Monterey*
- 10:00 – 11:30 a.m.** **Semi-Final Rounds (McGowan100, McGowan102, Morse B104, Morse B105, Center for the Blue Economy (CBE) Room 1 and 2)**
Wave 1 10:00 – 10:40 a.m. | Wave 2 10:50 – 11:30 a.m.
- 11:30 – 12:00 p.m.** **Lunch Served (Samson Center, 453 Van Buren St)**
- 12:00 – 2:00 p.m.** **Side Event: Analytical Tradecraft Workshop (Irvine Auditorium, McCone)**
James Plotts, U.S. Department of State/Central Intelligence Agency (Ret.)
- 2:00 – 2:20 p.m.** **Announcement of Finalists & Introduction of Final Round Judges (Irvine Auditorium, McCone)**
Safa Shahwan Edwards, Director, Capacity Building & Communities, Cyber Statecraft Initiative, Atlantic Council
- 2:30 – 4:30 p.m.** **Final Round (Irvine Auditorium, McCone)**

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4:45 – 5:00 p.m.

Announcement of Awards and Closing Ceremony (Irvine Auditorium, McCone)

Safa Shahwan Edwards, *Director, Capacity Building & Communities, Cyber Statecraft Initiative*, Atlantic Council

Karen Nershi, *Professor and Director, Cyber Collaborative*, Middlebury Institute of International Studies at Monterey